

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86STATE 343858

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DRAFTED BY: EUR/SOV/SOBI:KCLANG:KCL

APPROVED BY: S:THE SECRETARY

EUR:TWSIMONS, JR

HA:J MONTGOMERY

EUR/SOV/MR PARRIS

NEA/IAI:JBIGUS

EUR/SOV/SOBI:LDSELL

S/S-G:RBOUCHER

S/S:JFCOLLINS

EUR:RRIOGWAY

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TO AMEMBASSY MOSCOW IMMEDIATE

AMCONSUL Leningrad IMMEDIATE

INFO AMEMBASSY TEL AVIV

AMCONSUL JERUSALEM

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E.O. 12958: DECL: OADR

TAGS: PREL PHUM, UR, US

SUBJECT: SECRETARY'S MEETING WITH MORRIS ABRAM,
CONFERENCE OF PRESIDENTS OF MAJOR JEWISH ORGANIZATIONS

1. CONFIDENTIAL - ENTIRE TEXT.

2. SUMMARY: SECRETARY SHULTZ MET OCTOBER 27 WITH MORRIS ABRAM AND OTHER JEWISH LEADERS TO REPORT ON THE MEETINGS IN ICELAND. THE SECRETARY SAID THAT THE PRESIDENT HANDED GORBACHEV A PACKAGE OF MATERIALS CONCERNING SOVIET HUMAN RIGHTS COMMITMENTS UNDER INTERNATIONAL AGREEMENTS AND STATISTICS ON SOVIET JEWISH EMIGRATION. THE PRESIDENT EMPHASIZED THAT, AS A NATION OF IMMIGRANTS, AMERICANS CARE DEEPLY ABOUT HUMAN RIGHTS AND EMIGRATION. THE U.S. CONFIDENTIAL
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WILL BE FOLLOWING UP WITH THE SOVIETS IN VIENNA IN ESTABLISHING A MECHANISM FOR DISCUSSING HUMAN RIGHTS.
END SUMMARY.

3. ABRAM, WHO IS CHAIRMAN OF THE CONFERENCE OF PRESIDENTS OF MAJOR JEWISH ORGANIZATIONS AND CHAIRMAN OF THE NATIONAL CONFERENCE ON SOVIET JEWRY (NCSJ) WAS ACCOMPANIED BY CHAIRMAN OF THE COUNCIL OF JEWISH FEDERATIONS SHOSHANA CARDIN, PRESIDENT OF HADASSAH RUTH

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POPKIN, CONFERENCE OF PRESIDENTS EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

MALCOLM HOENLEIN, AND NCSJ EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR JERRY GOODMAN. PRESENT FROM THE DEPARTMENT WERE EUR ASSISTANT SECRETARY ROZANNE RIDGWAY AND DAS TOM SIMONS, AND HUMAN RIGHTS DAS JIM MONTGOMERY.

4. THE SECRETARY REPORTED THAT THE PRESIDENT RAISED HUMAN RIGHTS IN THE FIRST PRIVATE SESSION AND ON AT LEAST TWO OTHER OCCASIONS. THE SOVIETS KNOW THAT THE PRESIDENT FEELS STRONGLY, THE SECRETARY SAID. THE PRESIDENT EMPHASIZED THAT, AS A NATION OF IMMIGRANTS, AMERICANS CARE DEEPLY ABOUT HUMAN RIGHTS. WE LET THE SOVIETS KNOW THAT THIS IS NOT JUST A JEWISH ISSUE. WE'VE TOLD GORBACHEV HE CANNOT EXPECT A WARM WELCOME FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE IF THEY COME FOR A SUMMIT AND IF THERE IS NO IMPROVEMENT IN THEIR HUMAN RIGHTS PERFORMANCE. WE USE A DOUBLE-BARRELED APPROACH IN TALKING ABOUT HUMAN RIGHTS; WE TALK ABOUT INDIVIDUAL CASES, BUT WE ALSO LET THEM KNOW THAT THE RELEASE OF WELLKNOWN NAMES IS NOT ADDRESSING THE ISSUE. THEIR OVERALL PERFORMANCE MUST IMPROVE.

5. THE SECRETARY THANKED ABRAM FOR HIS ASSISTANCE IN PREPARING A PACKAGE OF MATERIAL WHICH THE PRESIDENT
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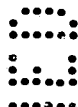
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HANDED TO GORBACHEV. THE PACKAGE WAS BASED ON THE OBLIGATIONS THE SOVIETS HAVE ASSUMED UNDER THE HELSINKI FINAL ACT AND THE UNIVERSAL DECLARATION ON HUMAN RIGHTS. IT DEFINED THE PROBLEM BY SHOWING STATISTICS ON SOVIET JEWISH EMIGRATION, AND GRAPHS SHOWING FALLING EMIGRATION FIGURES AND THE NUMBER OF SOVIET JEWS STILL WANTING TO LEAVE. GORBACHEV TOOK THE MATERIALS AND SAID THEY WOULD STUDY THEM. A DEPARTURE FROM PRACTICE IN THE GROMYKO DAYS, THE SECRETARY SAID.

6. HUMAN RIGHTS WERE ALSO DISCUSSED IN THE ALL-NIGHT SESSION OF THE WORKING GROUP CHAIRED BY BESSMERTNYKH AND ASSISTANT SECRETARY RIDGWAY FOR THE TWO SIDES. A WORK PROGRAM WAS DEVELOPED AND THE PUBLIC STATEMENT WHICH WOULD HAVE BEEN ISSUED AT THE END OF THE REYKJAVIK TALKS SAID THAT THE TWO SIDES WOULD BE CONTINUING DISCUSSIONS ON "HUMANITARIAN AND HUMAN RIGHTS ISSUES." THIS WOULD HAVE BEEN THE FIRST TIME THE SOVIETS USED THE PHRASE "HUMAN RIGHTS" IN AN OFFICIAL BILATERAL CONTEXT. ASSISTANT RIDGWAY ADDED THAT THE U.S. DELEGATION TRIED TO PUSH AHEAD ON THE ESTABLISHMENT OF A HUMANITARIAN REVIEW GROUP, BUT THAT AWAITS A POLITICAL DECISION ON THE SOVIETS' PART.

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8. WHEN ASKED ABOUT SUMMIT PROSPECTS, THE SECRETARY SAID HE WOULD HAVE IT PASS. THE ICELAND MEETING WAS DOMINATED BY SUBSTANTIVE ISSUES, NOT BY THE QUESTION OF THE NEXT SUMMIT. THE U.S. ALSO WANTED TO REMOVE THE IMPRESSION FROM SOVIET MINDS, HE SAID, THAT A SUMMIT WAS SOMETHING THE U.S. WAS DESPERATE FOR.

9. CONCERNING THE SOVIET THREAT TO MAKE PUBLIC THE PRESIDENT'S STATEMENTS ON ARMS CONTROL IN ICELAND, THE SECRETARY SAID IT WAS NOT A PROPER THING TO DO. WE MADE A LARGE AMOUNT OF PROGRESS IN ICELAND, THE SECRETARY SAID, AND NOT JUST ON HUMAN RIGHTS. WE ESTABLISHED THE BASIC ELEMENTS OF AN INF AGREEMENT, A NUCLEAR TESTING AGREEMENT, AND A 50 PERCENT REDUCTION IN STRATEGIC ARMS. "THE ISSUES WERE REARRANGED IN A PRODUCTIVE WAY." THE SOVIETS WERE TAUGHT THE LESSON, HOWEVER, THAT THE PRESIDENT IS PRETTY TOUGH, AND IS NOT GOING TO GIVE IN ON SOI. AS TO THE SOVIETS' MAKING PUBLIC STATEMENTS WHICH SHOW THE PRESIDENT TO BE IN FAVOR OF ABOLISHING NUCLEAR WEAPONS, "WELL, HE IS." OF COURSE, THE SECRETARY SAID, A WAY MUST BE FOUND TO REDRESS THE IMBALANCE IN CHEMICAL AND CONVENTIONAL WEAPONS.

10. ABRAM THANKED THE SECRETARY FOR THE USG'S EFFORTS ON HUMAN RIGHTS IN REYKJAVIK. HE SAID THAT HE SAW PROGRESS IN THE FACT THAT THE SOVIETS ACKNOWLEDGED THAT THEY'RE WILLING TO DISCUSS HUMAN RIGHTS. HE LIKENED THIS TO PASSING A JURISDICTIONAL BARRIER AND GETTING THE SUPREME COURT TO AGREE TO HEAR A CASE.

11. MINIMIZE CONSIDERED.
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